



began. “I came from a Hindi-medium school background and was not very well-versed in English. Fifteen of us from the same school got into BITS Pilani together and none of us could speak in English fluently!”

Being part of an institute like BITS, where students came in from all over the country and were fluent in English, language was a huge barrier for Satya in the initial days. He remembers how he would take down English notes in Hindi. “Once, during placements, a recruiter asked me what Osmosis was. I said ‘Sir, I don’t know what Osmosis means. If you can translate it for me in Hindi, then I can give you the answer’,” he laughs.

But not one to be bogged down by challenges, Satya quickly caught up with the others as he slowly and steadily learnt the language with the help of his peers. Whether it was teamwork, the importance of perseverance, or dedication and hard work, Satya credits his time at BITS Pilani with having helped build a different set of personality traits in him, which would otherwise not have been built.

Interestingly, while most final-year students eagerly wait for place-

Dr Satya Gupta’s Career Chart

1978 - Joined BITS Pilani
1983 - Joined IIT Delhi as a research assistant and received MTech
1988 - Went on to pursue his PhD from Old Dominion University in the USA
1992 - Joined Intel Corporation and became Director, ASIC Design, Intel Micro Electronics
2003 - Started his first venture – Open-Silicon
2005 - Co-Founded IESA
2009 - Started his second venture – Concept2Silicon
2012 - IESA Chairman for 2012-2013
2015 - Started his third venture – SenZopt Technologies
2018 - President, VLSI Society of India
2020 - Chairman, IESA for 2020-2021
2021 - Started EPIC Foundation along with Ajai Chowdhry and Arjun Malhotra, both HCL Founders
Currently - Actively working on India Semiconductor Mission

ments to take place, Satya had his eyes set on a different prize. It was a time when placements were not as structured as they are now, but companies like TCS, which provided high packages, were dream companies for students. But not for Satya.

Refusing to move with the crowd, Satya chose to pursue a different path for himself by opting for a Research Assistant position at IIT Delhi, where his first real interest in semiconductors began. Joining a project under the renowned Prof. Anshul Kumar, Satya learnt the intricacies of silicon while working at IIT Delhi, where he also obtained his master’s degree.

“I met a lot of fantastic people there and learnt a lot while working with tech-savvy people who helped me in understanding the complexities of tech.” And with these learnings in his heart and mind, Satya was ready to come yet another step closer to strengthening his relationship with silicon.

Love for teaching and moving to the USA

In 1988, while supercomputing was taking the technology world by storm, Satya decided to further his knowledge of technology

by moving to the United States to pursue his PhD at the Old Dominion University.

Living so far away from home in a different country with different cultures was a trying period for Satya. In a time when a one-minute call cost \$3, Satya tried hard to save his paltry student stipend and instead wrote letters back home. He also learnt how to cook Indian dishes as he tried to ease his homesickness and settle down in the United States where vegetarian food was a rare sight. He quickly became the go-to-guy if any student wanted to eat fresh *chapati* or *paratha*.

Satya, however, did not stray away from his desire to learn. He spent four years in Virginia, where he spent two years as a research assistant at NASA Langley Research Center, where he deepened his understanding of supercomputing.

During this time, Satya also took note of his love for teaching. “I always loved teaching people. I was always helping fellow students, clearing their doubts, and helping them with their assignments. I would spend time clearing their doubts and then go to my room to study at midnight.”

Hailing from Rajasthan, a state known for its harsh summers, the severity of the winters in the USA was not something that Satya was familiar with. One day, after attending a conference in Chicago during peak winter season, with no suitable winter clothing, Satya walked



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